

Eligibility, application and reasonable adjustments

Whether your three years count, what the application actually asks for, and how to get an adjustment approved in time

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PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
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— Summary

PCI's entry requirement is three years of professional experience in any field, counted on a full-time-equivalent basis, with no degree requirement. This document shows how to count those years honestly in the awkward cases — part-time, concurrent roles, self-employment, career breaks — what the application asks for and in what order the platform checks it, how experience is verified on a sample or risk basis, and how to request a reasonable adjustment so that it is in place before you book.

— About this document

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In one paragraph. PCI's entry requirement is three years of professional experience in any field, counted on a full-time-equivalent basis, with no degree requirement. This document shows how to count those years honestly in the awkward cases — part-time, concurrent roles, self-employment, career breaks — what the application asks for and in what order the platform checks it, how experience is verified on a sample or risk basis, and how to request a reasonable adjustment so that it is in place before you book.

Who this is for. Prospective candidates working out whether they qualify; career changers whose experience is not in project controls; employers and sponsors confirming that a member of staff is eligible before committing a budget; and any candidate who needs an adjustment to sit on equal terms.

— 1. The entry requirement

1.1 The rule

Three years of professional experience, in any field, counted on a full-time-equivalent basis. There is **no degree requirement**, and the experience **need not be in project controls**.

1.2 What the rule is doing

Two things, and it is worth being clear about both.

First, it sets a floor rather than a filter. Three years is long enough that a candidate has met a real deadline, a real budget and a real disagreement about a number, and short enough that it does not exclude the people the discipline actually recruits. Talent enters project controls from engineering, finance, construction, the trades and non-traditional routes, and a degree is not a reliable proxy for project-controls capability.

Second — and this is the part candidates most often miss — **meeting the eligibility criteria confirms only that you are ready to be assessed**. It is not a partial qualification, it does not contribute to your result, and no amount of experience beyond three years improves your standing. The credential is earned by passing the examination and nothing else.

1.3 What "professional experience" means

Paid work, in a role with defined responsibilities, for which you could describe what you were accountable for and name someone who could confirm it. Full-time study is not professional experience. Voluntary or unpaid work in a role with genuine responsibility is a case to raise with PCI before you apply rather than to assume in either direction. PCI interpretation: the test is responsibility and verifiability, not sector, seniority or job title.

— 2. Counting your three years

The four rules below are the published counting rules. They resolve most histories; §3 works one through arithmetically.

2.1 Part-time counts pro rata

Part-time work counts in proportion to full time. Two years at half-time contributes approximately one year. Use the contracted proportion of full-time hours in the same role, not the hours you actually worked in your busiest month.

2.2 Concurrent roles count once

Overlapping positions do not double the time. A period during which you held two roles is one period of experience. PCI interpretation: no calendar period is ever counted at more than one full-time equivalent, however many roles ran through it.

2.3 Self-employment and contracting count

Provided the work can be described and, if asked, verified. Being your own employer is not a disqualification; being unable to evidence what you did is a problem in any employment arrangement.

2.4 Career breaks do not reset the clock

Experience either side of a gap counts in full. Parental leave, illness, redundancy, study and travel break the continuity of employment, not the validity of the experience before it.

2.5 What is not covered by a rule

Some histories will still be ambiguous — a role that was nominally full-time but seasonal, an internship with real accountability, a family business without formal contracts. There is no published rule for every case, and inventing one here would be worse than saying so. Describe the position accurately in the application and raise it with PCI before booking. A case put honestly in advance is an eligibility question; the same case discovered later is an integrity question.

— 3. Worked example — counting a mixed history

Illustrative figures. The candidate and the dates are invented for the purpose of showing the arithmetic; nothing here describes a real person.

The history. A candidate has:

- 18 months as a full-time site engineer;
- 24 months as a cost analyst at 0.6 of full-time hours;
- of those same 24 months, 12 months also spent as a part-time lecturer at 0.4 of full-time hours;
- an 11-month career break;
- 9 months full-time as a self-employed contractor.

The calculation. Units are months, expressed as full-time equivalent (FTE), to one decimal place.

Period	Duration	FTE factor	FTE months	Rule applied
Site engineer	18	1.0	$18 \times 1.0 = 18.0$	Full-time
Cost analyst	24	0.6	$24 \times 0.6 = 14.4$	Pro rata (§2.1)
Lecturer (concurrent)	12	0.4	counted at 0.0	Concurrent (§2.2)
Career break	11	—	0.0	No credit, no reset (§2.4)
Self-employed contractor	9	1.0	$9 \times 1.0 = 9.0$	Self-employment (§2.3)

Total = $18.0 + 14.4 + 0.0 + 0.0 + 9.0 = 41.4$ FTE months = **3.45 years**.

The answer. 3.45 years is above the three-year requirement, so this candidate is eligible.

The assumptions the answer depends on. That the FTE factors are the contracted proportions and can be evidenced from contracts or payslips; that the lecturing months overlapped the cost-analyst role entirely, so no part of them falls outside it; and that the 11-month break contains no other paid work. Change any of those and the arithmetic changes. Note that the concurrent lecturing months are not lost because lecturing is worth less — they are not counted because the calendar period they occupy has already been counted once.

4. Declaring and verifying experience

4.1 What you declare

Roles, dates, and a brief description of your responsibilities. Write the description in terms of what you were accountable for rather than what the team delivered.

4.2 What to keep

Keep a simple record alongside your application, whether or not anyone asks for it:

- role title and employer or client;
- start and end dates, to the month;
- contracted proportion of full-time hours for any part-time period;
- one line on what you were actually responsible for;
- the name and current contact details of a person who could confirm it.

That record takes twenty minutes to write while you remember, and is very difficult to reconstruct two years later when a verification request arrives.

4.3 How verification works

PCI may verify what you declare **on a sample or risk basis**. Not every application is verified; verification is not a sign of suspicion; and being asked is not an adverse finding.

4.4 Misstatement

A misstatement of experience is treated as an **integrity matter, not a paperwork error**. Correcting your own declaration before it is relied upon is always the cheaper move, and PCI would rather receive a correction than discover a discrepancy.

— 5. The application

5.1 What must be in place before a booking will open

Application is fully online. The platform checks the following, and a booking will not open until every one is satisfied:

1. **Examination entitlement** — the fee paid, not refunded, failed or reversed.
2. **The entitlement is still live** — its scheduling deadline has not passed (see [CER-05](#) §2).
3. **Profile completeness** — including the country you will sit in.
4. **Identity document** — a government-issued photo identification document on file. The most recent document governs: if none has been uploaded, or the most recent was rejected, booking is blocked until you upload again. A freshly submitted document satisfies the gate; verification by staff is an audit action, not a queue you wait in.
5. **Policy consents** — all seven accepted at their current version (§5.2).
6. **Account standing** — no administrative hold, suspension or deactivation on the account.

A seventh condition sits outside your control: booking can be closed platform-wide, in which case no candidate can book.

Knowing this list is worth a support ticket. When "book" does not appear, the cause is almost always one of items 1 to 6, and you can resolve most of them yourself in ten minutes.

5.2 The seven consents

Before booking you accept, at their current version: the **candidate handbook**, the **examination rules**, the **proctoring consent**, the **privacy notice**, the **refund policy**, the **misconduct policy** and the **credential terms**. Each acceptance is recorded with its policy version and timestamp.

Two consequences follow. You cannot later say you were not told, because the version you accepted is on record. And PCI cannot quietly change a policy under you, because the same record shows which version you agreed to and a changed version has to be accepted afresh.

5.3 The name on your identification

The name on your booking must match your identification **exactly, character for character**. This is the most avoidable cause of exam-day failure. Check it the week before you sit, not the morning of.

— 6. Reasonable adjustments

6.1 The commitment

PCI provides reasonable adjustments so that candidates with disabilities or specific needs can demonstrate their capability on equal terms, **without compromising the standard**. Adjustments remove barriers that have nothing to do with the competence being assessed. They never alter what competence means: the same knowledge, the same skill, the same pass mark. The promise is a level field, never a lower bar.

6.2 Request before you book

Request an adjustment **from your account, before booking** — not on the day. This is not administrative preference; it is the only way the arrangement can actually work:

- extended time is configured in the platform in advance, and approved extra minutes genuinely extend the duration of your examination rather than being added by someone watching a clock;
- agreed rest breaks are recorded with the proctoring arrangements, so that a legitimate break is never flagged as an irregularity;
- assistive technology is checked for compatibility with the secure environment while there is still time to resolve a problem.

Requests should be submitted **[CONFIRM: the minimum notice period for a reasonable-adjustment request before booking or before the scheduled sitting]** in advance. Until that notice period is published, submit as early as you can and do not book until your request has been decided.

6.3 What you can request

The platform recognises four request categories: **extra time**, a **separate setting**, **assistive technology**, and **other** — the last existing precisely because a fixed list would fail the candidate whose need is not on it. Describe what you need and why, in your own words.

6.4 Evidence

Supporting evidence may be requested to determine the appropriate adjustment. The purpose is to match the adjustment to the barrier, not to test whether you deserve one.

6.5 How a request is handled

A request is submitted, reviewed, and decided as approved or rejected, with any approved extra minutes recorded against your account and applied automatically to your sitting. A decision carries a right of appeal like any other decision that affects you (CER-07 §6).

6.6 Confidentiality

Accommodation information is handled on a strict need-to-know basis and kept apart from assessment judgements. **The proctor knows that an arrangement exists, and what to do about it — not why it was granted.** Requesting an adjustment has no bearing on how your examination is marked, in either direction, and no marker sees it.

— 7. Accessibility beyond adjustments

Some accessibility is built in rather than requested. The examination interface is available in **seven languages** — English, Arabic, Spanish, French, Korean, Chinese and Russian — and the Arabic interface is laid out right-to-left rather than merely translated. Language choice is not an adjustment and needs no approval.

If a barrier you face is not addressed by either the built-in provision or the four request categories, raise it. A scheme that only accommodates the needs it anticipated is not accessible; it is lucky.

— 8. How this goes wrong

- **Waiting for eligibility to be "approved" before paying.** Eligibility is declared and verified on a sample or risk basis; there is no separate approval step that unlocks the rest of the process.
- **Counting concurrent roles twice.** The most common inflation in a mixed history, and the easiest to spot in verification. §2.2.
- **Counting a career break as disqualifying.** The opposite error, and it costs eligible people a credential they already qualify for. §2.4.
- **Uploading identification whose name differs by one character.** §5.3.
- **Requesting an adjustment after booking.** By then the configuration window has usually closed, and the choice becomes sitting without the adjustment or rescheduling. §6.2.
- **Assuming a rejected identity document has been chased.** The most recent document governs. If yours was rejected, nothing proceeds until you upload another.
- **Describing responsibilities as team achievements.** "The project delivered under budget" tells a verifier nothing about you. "I owned the cost report and the monthly variance analysis for a four-package scope" is verifiable.

— Related

- [CER-01 — Certification handbook — master](#) — the whole journey, of which eligibility is the first gate
- [CER-04 — Routes into PCI: standard, founding, honorary](#) — how eligibility differs by route
- [CER-05 — Booking, fees, rescheduling and cancellation](#) — what happens once the gates in §5.1 are clear
- [CAR-07 — Building a portfolio of evidence](#) — how to keep the experience record §4.2 asks for

— Sources and standards

- PCI platform application and booking gate, consent records and accommodation request records, verified August 2026 — the source of the six booking conditions in §5.1, the seven consents in §5.2 and the four request categories in §6.3.
- PCI Candidate Handbook ([docs/downloads/candidate-handbook.md](#)), 2026.

- PCI Publication Framework, [CANONICAL-FACTS.md](#) §4.4, August 2026.

— Status and version

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